glance, this 60,000$ VR camera might appear to be a futuristic globe on a stick, but hold no illusions, the thing comes with 8 2K x 2K synchronized sensors giving it a 360 x 180 full spherical video coverage area with omni-directional audio coverage too. The media module supports up to 45min of 30fps video recording in the form of a single video file. At 4.2kgs, you might soon be thanking the makers for the stand the device comes with, because the official tripod accessories are not out yet, and even when they are, you might just have run out of funds with the camera itself.

From the quirky Giroptic 360 Camera to the complicated Freedom360 GoPro mount (Six GoPro Hero4 cameras with one on each direction is definitely complicated!), VR cameras are coming in all shapes and sizes, and to try and cover all of them here would be a futile exercise for a Fastrack. Let us wait for them to actually hit the markets and then go for the detailed reviews.

Note: If you're interested in capturing the scent of a memory along with the visuals and the audio, you might like to check out Madeleine smell camera at *http://dgit.in/MadeleineCam*

Interactive VR

From static VR content, let us move towards the interactable ones. Right now, we are talking about all those VR games, demos, animation movies etc Developing and designing for a 3D space is not something new and game developers have been developing brilliant first person games for ages. Most of us are familiar with the Call of Duty ingame cutscenes which are good examples of interactive first person animation. Bringing all of that into Virtual Reality as an experience requires incorporating motion sensing, position tracking and an immersion-oriented approach to design.

Google's Best Practices for Developing Cardboard apps are a good place to start before actually beginning the design. The guideline covers all the considerations that a designer needs to make and highlights the essential points that need to be followed to make the VR experience as comfortable to the user as possible. Few of the important points to be kept track of are :-

- Constant head tracking
- Constant Velocity
- Emulating real life in design
- Changes in brightness

You can go through the entire guideline at *http://dgit.in/VRBestPractices.* Needless to say, Google's Cardboard SDK for Android is your best bet if you are setting out to design VR for smartphone-based VR headsets.